

IDEA

1. Passage anchor

> “I was always afraid of saying the wrong thing, so I often stayed silent even when I had **an idea**.”

Passage meaning

idea = a thought, suggestion, or opinion that comes into your mind

想法；主意；念頭

Here, the speaker had something meaningful to contribute in class but lacked the confidence to say it aloud.

Practice

1. I had **an idea**, but I was too nervous to share it.
我有一個**想法**，但太緊張，不敢說出來。
2. She raised her hand whenever she had **an idea** worth discussing.
每當她有值得討論的**想法**時，就會舉手。

Core meanings of IDEA

2. idea — a thought or suggestion

= a thought, plan, or suggestion that comes into your mind

想法；主意；點子

This is the central everyday meaning and the passage sense.

Examples

1. I have an **idea** for the project.
我對這個專案有一個**想法**。
2. That's a great **idea**.
那是個很棒的**主意**。

3. have an idea

= think of something or have a suggestion

****有一個想法；想到一個點子****

Examples

1. I've just had an ****idea****.

我剛剛想到一個****主意****。

2. She had an ****idea**** for improving the lesson.

她想到一個改善課程的****方法 / 點子****。

Very high-value pattern.

4. come up with an idea

= think of or create an idea

****想出一個點子；提出想法****

Examples

1. We need to ****come up with an idea**** quickly.

我們需要很快****想出一個點子****。

2. She ****came up with a clever idea****.

她****想出了一個很聰明的點子****。

Plan / proposal

5. idea — plan or possible course of action

= a plan or suggestion about what could be done

****主意；方案；構想****

Examples

1. My ****idea**** is to start earlier.

我的****主意****是早一點開始。

2. They discussed several ****ideas**** for reducing costs.

他們討論了幾個降低成本的****方案 / 構想****。

6. idea for something

= a suggestion or concept intended for a particular purpose

****關於.....的構想；.....的點子****

Examples

1. Do you have any ****ideas for the presentation****?

你對這份簡報有什麼****想法****嗎？

2. She suggested an ****idea for a new campaign****.

她提出了一個新宣傳活動的****構想****。

Concept / mental understanding

7. idea — concept

= a general concept or thought about something

****概念；觀念****

Examples

1. Children gradually develop the ****idea of fairness****.

孩子逐漸形成「公平」這個****概念****。

2. The ****idea of freedom**** means different things to different people.

「自由」這個****概念****對不同的人有不同意義。

This is more abstract than a practical suggestion.

8. idea of something

= the concept or mental representation of something

****.....的概念；對.....的理解****

Examples

1. His ****idea of success**** is very different from mine.

他對成功的****理解 / 觀念****和我很不一樣。

2. Our ****idea of a good life**** changes over time.

我們對美好生活的**觀念**會隨時間改變。

Opinion / belief

9. idea — opinion or belief

= a belief, view, or opinion about something

看法；觀念；想法

Examples

1. I don't agree with his **ideas about education**.

我不同意他對教育的**看法**。

2. Her **ideas** changed after travelling abroad.

她出國旅行後，很多**觀念**改變了。

10. have an idea that...

= believe or suppose that something may be true

有.....的想法；認為.....

Examples

1. I had an **idea that he might refuse**.

我隱約**覺得他可能會拒絕**。

2. She had the **idea that everyone was judging her**.

她有一種**大家都在評判她的想法**。

This can sound like a belief rather than a proposal.

Knowledge / awareness

11. have no idea

= not know at all

完全不知道；毫無頭緒

Examples

1. I have ****no idea**** where he went.

我****完全不知道****他去哪裡了。

2. She had ****no idea**** what to say.

她****完全不知道****該說什麼。

Extremely common idiom.

12. have some idea

= have a partial understanding or some knowledge

****有一些概念；大概知道****

Examples

1. Do you have any ****idea**** how difficult this is?

你知不知道這件事有多難？

2. I have some ****idea of what happened****.

我大概****知道發生了什麼****。

13. give someone an idea of something

= help someone understand or imagine something

****讓某人了解；使某人有概念****

Examples

1. The photos give you an ****idea of the size**** of the building.

這些照片可以讓你****大概了解建築有多大****。

2. This example should give you an ****idea of how the system works****.

這個例子應該能讓你****大概了解系統怎麼運作****。

Impression / approximate understanding

14. get the idea

= understand the main point or principle

****明白意思；懂了****

Examples

1. You don't need to read every example—you ****get the idea****.
你不需要每個例子都讀，你已經****懂意思了****。
2. After a few demonstrations, I ****got the idea****.
看過幾次示範後，我就****明白了****。

15. get the wrong idea

= misunderstand someone's meaning, intention, or situation

****誤會；產生錯誤印象****

Examples

1. Don't ****get the wrong idea****—we're just friends.
別****誤會****，我們只是朋友。
2. I hope she didn't ****get the wrong idea**** from my comment.
我希望她沒有因為我的話而****誤解我的意思****。

Purpose / intention

16. the idea is to...

= the purpose, intention, or main plan is to...

****重點 / 目的就是.....****

Examples

1. The ****idea is to keep things simple****.
****重點就是****把事情保持簡單。
2. The ****idea is to encourage discussion****.
****目的在於****鼓勵討論。

Very useful explanatory construction.

17. the whole idea

= the main purpose or principle behind something

****整個構想；核心目的****

Examples

1. The ****whole idea**** is to make learning less stressful.

****整個構想的核心****就是讓學習壓力更小。

2. That goes against the ****whole idea**** of the project.

那與這個專案的****整體理念****相違背。

Image / impression in the mind

18. idea — mental picture or impression

= an image or impression you form in your mind

****印象；想像****

Examples

1. I had a very different ****idea of what the place would look like****.

我原本對那個地方會長什麼樣有完全不同的****想像****。

2. The description gave me a clear ****idea of the room****.

那段描述讓我對房間有了清楚的****印象****。

Principle / philosophy

19. idea — principle or philosophy

= a belief or principle that guides thought or behavior

****理念；思想****

Examples

1. The company was built around the ****idea of simplicity****.

這家公司以「簡潔」這個****理念****為核心。

2. The movement promoted new political and social ****ideas****.

這個運動推動新的政治與社會****思想****。

Creative concept

20. idea — creative concept for a work

= an original concept for a book, film, design, product, etc.

****創意；構想；點子****

Examples

1. She had an ****idea for a novel****.
她有一個小說的****構想****。
2. The designer presented three different ****ideas****.
設計師提出了三個不同的****創意方案****。

Possibility / suggestion

21. good idea / bad idea

= sensible or unwise course of action

****好主意 / 壞主意****

Examples

1. Taking an umbrella is a ****good idea****.
帶把傘是個****好主意****。
2. Driving when exhausted is a ****bad idea****.
累到不行還開車是個****壞主意****。

22. it might be a good idea to...

= polite way to suggest an action

****也許最好.....；不妨.....****

Examples

1. It might be a ****good idea to leave early****.
也許****早點出發會比較好****。

2. It would be a **good idea to check the details first**.

最好先確認一下細節。

High-value pragmatic use.

Acceptance / enthusiasm

23. like the idea of something

= feel positive about the possibility or concept of something

喜歡.....這個想法；覺得.....不錯

Examples

1. I like the **idea of working from home**.

我喜歡**在家工作的想法**。

2. She liked the **idea of studying abroad**.

她覺得**出國讀書這個想法不錯**。

24. hate the idea of something

= strongly dislike the possibility or thought of something

很不喜歡.....這個想法；一想到.....就不喜歡

Examples

1. He hates the **idea of speaking in public**.

他很討厭**公開演講這件事**。

2. I hate the **idea of wasting food**.

我很不喜歡**浪費食物這件事**。

Fixed expressions

25. have no idea

= know absolutely nothing about something

完全不知道；毫無頭緒

Examples

1. I have **no idea what happened**.
我**完全不知道發生了什麼**。
2. He had **no idea how to respond**.
他**完全不知道該怎麼回應**。

26. any idea...?

= do you know...?

知道.....嗎？

Examples

1. **Any idea where she is?**
你**知道她在哪裡嗎？**
2. Do you have **any idea when the meeting starts**?
你**知道會議什麼時候開始嗎？**

Common conversational shortcut.

27. that's the idea

= yes, that is exactly the intended principle or action

對，就是這樣；就是這個意思

Examples

1. "So I should focus on meaning, not perfection?" "***That's the idea.***"
「所以我應該專注意思，而不是完美？」 「**對，就是這個意思。**」
2. "Keep your shoulders relaxed?" "***That's the idea.***"
「肩膀保持放鬆？」 「**沒錯，就是這樣。**」

28. that's an idea

= that is a possible or interesting suggestion

****這倒是個主意****

Examples

1. “Why don’t we meet earlier?” “****That’s an idea.****”
「我們何不早一點見面？」 「****這倒是個主意。****」
2. “We could ask the students.” “****That’s an idea.****”
「我們可以問學生。」 「****這個主意不錯。****」

Distinct from ****That’s the idea.****

29. big idea

A. important or central concept

****核心概念；重大構想****

1. The course focuses on a few ****big ideas****.
這門課聚焦幾個****核心概念****。

B. informal: ambitious plan

****大膽想法；大計畫****

2. He has a ****big idea**** for the company.
他對公司有一個****大膽構想****。

30. bright idea

= clever idea; sometimes used sarcastically for a bad idea

****好點子；聰明主意；有時反諷為餿主意****

Examples

1. That was a ****bright idea****.
那真是個****好點子****。
2. Whose ****bright idea**** was it to hold the meeting at 6 a.m.?
是誰出的這個「****好主意****」，竟然早上六點開會？

Tone determines whether it is sincere or sarcastic.

Related forms

31. ideal

Historically related, but now a distinct lexical item.

Adjective

= perfect or most suitable

****理想的；最合適的****

Noun

= principle or perfect standard

****理想；理念****

Examples

1. This is an ****ideal place**** to study.

這是個****理想的讀書地點****。

2. She refused to give up her ****ideals****.

她拒絕放棄自己的****理想 / 理念****。

Because ****ideal**** has developed significantly, it deserves separate curation if needed.

32. idealistic

= believing strongly in high ideals, sometimes more than practical realities justify

****理想主義的；理想化的****

Examples

1. He was young and ****idealistic****.

他年輕而且很****理想主義****。

2. Her plan may be too ****idealistic****.

她的計畫可能太****理想化****。

33. idealism

= belief in or pursuit of ideals

****理想主義****

Examples

1. Youthful ****idealism**** influenced his choices.
年輕時的****理想主義****影響了他的選擇。
2. The novel contrasts ****idealism**** with practical reality.
這部小說把****理想主義****與現實作對比。

Countability

34. idea is usually countable

- * an idea
- * one idea
- * several ideas

Examples

1. I have ****an idea****.
我有一個****想法****。
2. We discussed several ****ideas****.
我們討論了幾個****想法****。

Key contrasts

35. idea vs thought

****thought****

= anything that passes through the mind; often more temporary or general

****想法；念頭****

****idea****

= a thought that often has clearer content, concept, or possible use

****想法；主意；概念****

Compare:

> A strange **thought** crossed my mind.

> 一個奇怪的念頭閃過我的腦海。

> I have an **idea** for the project.

> 我對專案有個主意。

36. idea vs opinion

opinion

= judgment or personal view about something

意見 ; 看法

idea

is broader and can be:

* suggestion

* concept

* plan

* belief

* mental image

Compare:

> What is your **opinion** of the plan?

> 你對這個計畫有什麼看法？

> Do you have any **ideas** for improving the plan?

> 你有什麼改善計畫的主意嗎？

37. idea vs plan

idea

= thought or concept that may still be undeveloped

plan

= more organized intended course of action

計畫

Compare:

> I have an **idea** for a trip.

> 我有一個旅行的想法。

> We have a detailed **plan** for the trip.

> 我們有一套詳細的旅行計畫。

38. idea vs concept

concept

= abstract general notion, often academic or technical

概念

idea

= broader everyday word for concepts, thoughts, suggestions, and beliefs

Compare:

> the **concept** of justice

> 正義的概念

> an **idea** for a new lesson

> 新課程的想法

39. idea vs suggestion

suggestion

= idea specifically offered for someone to consider

建議

idea

= any thought or possible plan

A person can have an idea without presenting it as a suggestion.

40. idea vs belief

belief

= something regarded as true

信念；相信的事情

idea

can refer to a belief, but does not necessarily imply commitment to its truth.

Meaning map

The central concept of **idea** is:

something represented in the mind

From this develop:

Thought

have an idea

→ **想法；念頭**

Suggestion

good idea

→ **主意**

Plan

idea for a project

→ **構想**

Concept

idea of freedom

→ **概念**

Opinion/belief

ideas about education

→ **觀念；看法**

Knowledge

have no idea

→ **不知道**

Mental impression

give someone an idea of something

→ **使某人大概了解**

Purpose

the idea is to...

→ **目的 / 核心做法是.....**

The passage uses the basic thought/suggestion branch:

something comes into the speaker's mind that could be expressed in class.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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idea — thought/suggestion	出現在腦中的想法、主意或可提出的意見
have an idea	想到一個主意 / 腦中有一個想法
come up with an idea	主動想出一個新的點子或方法
idea — plan/proposal	對應該做什麼提出的構想、方案或主意
idea for something	為某個目的、作品或問題提出的構想
idea — concept	用來理解某個抽象事物的概念 / 觀念
idea of something	對某事物形成的概念、理解或看法
idea — opinion/belief	對某件事所持有的觀念、看法或信念
have no idea	完全不知道；毫無頭緒
have some idea	對某件事有部分了解或大概概念
give someone an idea of...	讓某人大概了解、想像或掌握某事
get the idea	理解主要意思、原則或做法
get the wrong idea	對某人的意思、關係或情況產生錯誤理解
the idea is to...	某個做法的主要目的 / 核心原則是.....
idea — mental image/impression	對某件事在腦中形成的印象或想像
idea — principle/philosophy	支持某種制度、做法或觀點的理念 / 思想
creative idea	用於作品、設計、產品等的創意 / 構想
good/bad idea	合理、值得做 / 不合理、不值得做的主意
it might be a good idea to...	委婉建議某人做某事；也許最好.....
like the idea of...	對某種可能性或做法抱有好感
that's the idea	表示對方已理解正確原則或做法；對，就是這樣
that's an idea	表示某個提議值得考慮；這倒是個主意
bright idea	聰明點子；有時以反諷語氣指不太好的主意
ideal	理想的 / 理想、理念；與 idea 歷史相關但現代已是獨立詞項

Passage recap

> "...so I often stayed silent even when I had **an idea**."

Here:

****idea**** = ****a thought or contribution that the speaker could have expressed****

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* ****想法****

* ****主意****

* ****念頭****

* contextually: ****即使我心裡有想法，也常常保持沉默****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****idea**** in the passage

= ****a thought, opinion, or suggestion that comes into your mind****

****想法；主意；念頭****

It does not specifically mean an abstract academic ****概念**** or a fully developed ****計畫**** here. The focus is simply that the speaker ****had something to say but lacked the confidence to say it****.